

2. Analyze your rent or housing payment. Determine how long you could maintain it if you lost your current income. Is your current housing situation putting you at financial risk? Could you use your housing as an investment to help build wealth *and* simultaneously decrease financial risk?
3. Start taking a thirty- to sixty-minute daily walk around where you live and/or work. While getting exercise, note how many properties are currently for sale or rent. Start getting a sense of your local market. What do properties cost? What do they rent for? How long do they take to sell? Pay attention to what makes some properties more attractive than others. As you do this, start to think about ways you could add value to real estate deals. Are you handy? Do you have cash that could enable you to buy properties quickly at discounts? Do you have access to favorable financing? Could you find good deals for other investors for a small profit?